Chicken and Broccoli Penne

Main dishes | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Cut chicken into 3/4-inch pieces, prepare broccoli florets, and freshly grate cheeses. Combine the dry seasonings before cooking. Cook pasta and broccoli together while sauce simmers.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Italian seasoning, mustard powder, and optional pepper flakes

Bowl B - Parmesan and Asiago, freshly grated

- [ ] 2 large boneless, skinless chicken breasts, cut into 3/4-inch pieces
- [ ] Lemon pepper seasoning
- [ ] 4 tablespoons olive oil
- [ ] 1 cup dry white wine see notes
- [ ] 6 tablespoons butter
- [ ] 6 cloves garlic
- [ ] 4 tablespoons flour
- [ ] 1.5 cup chicken broth
- [ ] 2.5 cups half and half
- [ ] 2 teaspoon hot sauce
- [ ] 8 cups broccoli florets
- [ ] 1.5 cup Parmesan, freshly grated [Bowl B]
- [ ] 0.5 cup Asiago can also use all parmesan., freshly grated [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 lb. Penne
- [ ] 4 teaspoons freshly squeezed lemon juice

Seasonings:

- [ ] 2 teaspoon Italian seasonings [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 teaspoon mustard powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 pinch red pepper flakes optional [Bowl A]

1. Prepare and cook

1. Combine 2 tsp Italian seasoning, 1 tsp mustard powder, and 2 pinches red pepper flakes (optional). Set aside.

2. Season 2 large chicken breasts, cut into 3/4-inch pieces, with lemon pepper seasoning (amount unspecified). Heat 4 tbsp olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Cook the chicken 2-3 minutes per side until browned; remove and set aside.

3. Bring a large pot of salted pasta water to a boil while you begin to prepare the sauce as outlined below.

4. Add 1 cup dry white wine to the chicken skillet over medium heat. Scrape up the browned bits and reduce by half, about 4 minutes.

5. Add 6 tbsp butter and 6 cloves garlic (prep unspecified); cook 1 minute. Stir in 4 tbsp flour and cook 1-2 minutes, stirring continuously.

6. Gradually stir in 1 1/2 cups chicken broth, then 2 1/2 cups half-and-half. Add 2 tsp hot sauce and the reserved seasoning mixture. Bring to a boil, reduce to a simmer, and partially cover.

7. Boil 1 lb penne to al dente according to its package. Add 8 cups broccoli florets during the last 4 minutes; drain.

8. Reduce sauce heat to low and slowly stir in 1 1/2 cups freshly grated Parmesan and 1/2 cup freshly grated Asiago (or additional Parmesan).

9. Remove from heat and stir in 4 tsp lemon juice. Add the cooked pasta, broccoli, and chicken; stir to combine. Taste and season with salt if desired.

Notes

Grate the cheese from a wedge and avoid using packaged grated cheese. It will melt and taste much better. I use Belgioioso Parmesan and Asiago cheese.

Make sure the base of the sauce isn't too hot when the cheese is added, or the dairy can separate and result in a grainy consistency.

White Wine: Dry white wine like Sauvignon Blanc, Chardonnay, or Pinot Grigio are best in this recipe and pair well with lemon. Chicken Broth may be used if you don't cook with wine.

The hot sauce is a subtle flavor enhancer and doesn't make this spicy. I use Frank's Hot Sauce. The mustard powder is also a flavor enhancer that can't be tasted outright.

Frozen broccoli may be used instead of fresh, it's already blanched so you may want to give it 3 minutes of cooking time instead of 4.

The ingredient list appears scaled up while the saved nutrition/servings text still says four servings; no yield or nutrition has been assumed.

Garlic prep is not specified in the saved recipe.